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Chihiro WATANABE

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Education

Hitotsubashi University, Tokyo, Japan
Ph.D. in Economics

Apr 2026 –

Hitotsubashi University, Tokyo, Japan
M.A. in Economics

Apr 2024 – Mar 2026

Thesis: *"Testing a Macroeconomic Model of Mental Health: Evidence from Micro-Level Causal Inference"*

Hitotsubashi University, Tokyo, Japan
B.A. in Economics, Valedictorian (*Summa Cum Laude*)

Apr 2020 – Mar 2024

Research Interests

- Health Economics (Mental Health)
- Information Economics (Rational Inattention)
- Computational Psychiatry

Research

Work in Progress

- **Rational Delusions** (joint with Hiroki Oi, M.D., Ph.D., psychiatrist and clinical researcher)
 - Initiated an interdisciplinary collaboration integrating economic theory with psychiatric and clinical insights.
 - Develop a rational-inattention model of delusional belief updating in which limited information-processing capacity provides a unified account of the “paradox of delusions”: the coexistence of two seemingly contradictory features, jumping to conclusions (JTC)—large shifts toward delusional beliefs based on weak evidence—and bias against disconfirmatory evidence (BADE)—insufficient belief revision even in response to strong counterevidence.
- **Social Epidemiology of Mental Health** (joint with Takashi Oshio)
 - Explore machine-learning approaches, including decision trees and clustering, to identify data-driven multidimensional deprivation profiles associated with mental health risk using Japanese panel data.

Master's Thesis

- **Testing a Macroeconomic Model of Mental Health: Evidence from Micro-Level Causal Inference**
 - Replicated in Julia a heterogeneous-agent life-cycle model in which mental health shapes economic decisions through rumination and pessimistically distorted beliefs.
 - Evaluated its quantitative implications using PSID panel data and staggered adoption of state mental health parity laws within a staggered difference-in-differences framework, bridging structural modeling with reduced-form causal inference.

Research Assistant Experience

- QuantEcon *May 2026 –*
 - Supervisors: Prof. Thomas J. Sargent and Prof. John Stachurski
 - Contribute to maintaining and modernizing open-source materials in computational economics, including NumPy/Numba revisions and textbook review.
- Institute of Economic Research (IER), Hitotsubashi University *Aug 2021 – Mar 2024*
 - Supervisors: Prof. Reiko Gotoh and Prof. Ryo Kambayashi
 - Cleaned and organized survey data for a capability-based study of older adults and persons with disabilities in Kunitachi City.

Fellowships, Honors & Awards

(HU stands for Hitotsubashi University.)

Best Presentation Award, Four-University Joint Research Presentation Meeting, HU	<i>2026</i>
Selected as the top presentation among 70 posters in the JST SPRING Program.	
JST SPRING Fellowship (“The Bridge to the Future” in HU)	<i>2026 – Present</i>
Moritani Ikueikai Scholarship	<i>2025 – 2026</i>
Valedictorian, HU	<i>2024</i>
<i>Summa Cum Laude</i> (President’s Award), HU Economics	<i>2024</i>
President’s Award (for Outstanding Achievement in a Paper Competition), HU	<i>2024</i>
Scholarship for Academic Excellence, HU	<i>2023 – 2024</i>
President’s Award (for Highest Academic Performance in Economics, 2022), HU	<i>2023</i>

Teaching Experience

- Intermediate Macroeconomics (Master’s level) *Fall 2024*
 - Instructor: Prof. Takashi Kano
 - Grading of assignments and exams / Office hours (student support)

Skills

Programming: Julia, Stata, Python, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Languages: Japanese (native), English

Tools: Git, Overleaf, VS Code